POT

PRODUCT VISION & STRATEGIC BUILD SPECIFICATION · VIBEATHON 2026

Money moves better together.

POT is a social group-payment platform built on Base that makes it effortless for people to collect, coordinate, hold and distribute money together.

It transforms informal group money collection into a simple, transparent and programmable experience.

A user creates a POT, sets a financial goal, invites participants, collects USDC contributions and distributes the funds according to clearly defined rules.

No spreadsheets. No chasing people through group chats. No confusion about who has paid.

POT combines the accessibility of a consumer fintech app with the transparency and programmability of on-chain payments.

1. Product thesis

The problem we're solving

People constantly need to pool money.

Consider everyday situations:

- Friends collecting money for a birthday.
- Families contributing towards an emergency.
- Groups organizing trips.
- Communities funding events.
- Teams collecting money for shared purchases.
- Creators collecting contributions from their audience.
- Event organizers collecting payments from attendees.

The underlying problem is surprisingly consistent.

Collecting money from multiple people is still unnecessarily complicated.

Today, organizers often rely on:

- Bank transfers and manual reconciliation.
- WhatsApp reminders.
- Screenshots as payment evidence.

- Spreadsheets to track contributors.
- One person's personal bank account to hold everyone's money.
- Manual refunds when plans change.

This creates friction, mistrust, administrative overhead and unnecessary disputes.

POT replaces this fragmented process with a shared financial workspace.

Our core insight

The opportunity isn't simply to make sending money easier.

It's to make coordinating money between people easier.

That distinction defines the entire product.

2. Product positioning

POT

Create a pot. Bring people together. Make things happen.

POT is where groups turn shared intentions into funded outcomes.

Base-nativeUSDC paymentsConsumer fintechSocial commerce

What POT is

- A consumer group-payment application.
- A shared contribution and funding platform.
- A programmable financial coordination layer.
- A social distribution product.
- An infrastructure opportunity for future third-party integrations.

What POT is not

- A cryptocurrency exchange.
- A DeFi yield aggregator.
- A speculative investment platform.
- A gambling application.
- A generic crowdfunding clone.
- A token-launch platform.

We are building a useful financial product first.

3. Target customers

We should launch with a focused consumer audience, then expand.

Segment	Primary use case
Friend groups	Birthdays, trips, gifts
Families	Shared expenses and emergency collections
Communities	Events and group activities
Creators	Audience contributions
Event organizers	Tickets and group bookings
Small businesses	Shared purchases and collections

Initial beachhead market

Friend groups and community organizers.

Why?

- They already coordinate through social messaging.
- Their payment needs are frequent and understandable.
- Every organizer can invite multiple new users.
- The product is easy to demonstrate.
- The use case does not require complicated financial education.

We should not initially try to become a complete business banking platform.

4. Core product experience

4.1 Create a POT

Creating a pot should take less than a minute.

The organizer provides:

- Pot name.
- Description.
- Cover image.
- Target amount.
- Contribution currency.
- Deadline.
- Contribution rules.
- Payout conditions.
- Visibility setting.

Examples:

POT	Target
Sarah’s Birthday	$500
Lagos Weekend Trip	$1,200
Community Meetup	$800
New Office Equipment	$2,000

Every pot receives a unique shareable URL.

4.2 Invite contributors

POT must make invitations effortless.

Supported distribution:

- WhatsApp.
- Telegram.
- X.
- Copy invitation link.
- QR code.
- Direct sharing.

People should be able to view a pot before connecting a wallet.

The ideal onboarding flow is:

- Open invitation.
- Understand the purpose.
- View target and progress.
- Choose contribution amount.
- Connect or create a wallet.
- Confirm contribution.

We should minimize wallet friction, not force Web3 terminology onto mainstream users.

4.3 Contributions

Users contribute USDC on Base.

Contribution functionality:

- Custom contribution amounts.
- Suggested contribution amounts.
- Minimum contribution rules where applicable.
- Transaction status.
- Contribution history.
- Transaction explorer links.
- Contributor privacy preferences.

Every successful contribution must be verifiable.

The application must distinguish between:

- Initiated transactions.
- Pending transactions.
- Confirmed transactions.
- Failed transactions.

A pending transaction must never be counted as funded money.

4.4 Shared financial dashboard

Each pot has a live dashboard.

It displays:

- Funding progress.
- Amount collected.
- Remaining target.
- Number of contributors.
- Contribution history.
- Deadline.
- Recent activity.
- Payout status.

The dashboard should feel alive.

When someone contributes, the group sees the progress change.

This creates social reinforcement and encourages additional participation.

4.5 Payouts

This is one of the most important components.

POT must support explicit payout rules.

For the MVP, support:

Organizer-controlled payout

The organizer can request withdrawal after the required conditions are met.

Target-based payout

The pot becomes eligible for payout once its funding target is reached.

Deadline-based resolution

The pot resolves according to its configured rules when the deadline arrives.

Refunds

If a refundable pot fails to reach its target, contributors can claim refunds according to the contract rules.

We must not imply that funds are automatically returned unless the deployed contract actually enforces that behavior.

All financial rules must be visible before contribution.

5. Social layer and engagement

This is what separates POT from a basic payment utility.

We want people to enjoy using the product and have reasons to return.

5.1 Activity feed

Each pot has a social activity feed.

Examples:

- Alice created a pot.
- James contributed $50.
- The group reached 50% of its target.
- Sarah shared the pot.
- The target was reached.
- The organizer completed the payout.

Users can react to activities and celebrate milestones.

5.2 Contribution milestones

POT should celebrate collective progress.

Examples:

- First contribution.
- 25% funded.
- Halfway funded.
- 75% funded.
- Fully funded.
- Successfully completed.

Milestones generate shareable graphics.

5.3 Shareable pot cards

Every pot should generate attractive social cards.

Examples:

- We just raised $500!
- 12 friends funded this trip.
- Our community reached its goal.
- This pot is 80% funded.

These should be optimized for WhatsApp Status, Instagram Stories, Telegram and X.

This is a fundamental growth feature, not an optional design detail.

5.4 Reputation and achievements

Introduce a lightweight achievement system.

Achievement	Requirement
First Pot	Create your first pot
First Contribution	Complete your first contribution
Community Builder	Successfully organize five pots
Goal Getter	Successfully fund a pot
Early Supporter	Contribute to a newly created pot
Super Organizer	Successfully complete 20 pots

Achievements can initially be off-chain.

Later, selected achievements can become portable Base credentials or collectible badges.

We should avoid issuing an NFT for every ordinary interaction.

6. Product differentiation

The competitive opportunity is not that nobody has built group payments before.

Products already exist for group expenses, collections and crowdfunding.

Our differentiation must come from how these capabilities work together.

Existing experience	POT's approach
Bank transfer collections	Programmable USDC collections
WhatsApp payment coordination	Dedicated shared financial workspace
Manual payment tracking	Verifiable transaction history
Individual organizers holding funds	Smart-contract-controlled settlement
Static fundraising pages	Interactive group contribution experience
Generic payment links	Purpose-built, shareable group pots

Our differentiating product principles

- Anyone should understand a pot without knowing what a blockchain is.
- Creating a pot should be faster than creating a spreadsheet.
- Every contribution should be independently verifiable.
- Financial rules must be transparent.
- Inviting someone should be effortless.
- The product should be useful even without speculative incentives.

7. Web3 and Base architecture

Base is the settlement layer, not a marketing accessory.

7.1 Blockchain infrastructure

Component	Technology
Network	Base
Settlement asset	USDC
Smart contracts	Solidity
Contract development	Foundry
Contract interaction	viem / wagmi
Wallet onboarding	Coinbase Smart Wallet / compatible wallet infrastructure
Transaction sponsorship	Optional paymaster
Contract verification	BaseScan

7.2 Smart contract architecture

I recommend a modular architecture.

```
flowchart TD
    A[User] --> B[POT Web Application]
    B --> C[Wallet Connection]
```

```
B --> D[Supabase]
B --> E[POT Factory Contract]
E --> F[Individual POT Contract]
F --> G[USDC Token Contract]
F --> H[Contribution Records]
F --> I[Payout and Refund Logic]
G --> J[Base Network]
I --> J
J --> K[Event Indexer]
K --> D
D --> B
```

Contract components

POT Factory

- Deploys individual pot instances.
- Maintains pot registration.
- Emits creation events.
- Provides discoverability.

POT Instance

- Stores pot configuration.
- Accepts approved USDC contributions.
- Records contributors and amounts.
- Enforces contribution and deadline rules.
- Controls payout and refund eligibility.
- Emits events for frontend indexing.

Settlement module

Handles:

- Successful payout.
- Refund eligibility.
- Payout authorization.
- Campaign closure.

For the hackathon, a simple factory and individual pot contracts are sufficient. We should not introduce unnecessary proxy systems or complicated upgradeability.

7.3 Financial safety requirements

This is non-negotiable.

- No private keys stored in the application database.
- No administrator backdoor for withdrawing contributor funds.
- No arbitrary contract calls from the frontend.
- Reentrancy protection.
- Checks-effects-interactions pattern.
- Safe ERC-20 transfer handling.
- Strict access control.
- Deadline and target validation.
- Protection against double refunds.
- Protection against double payouts.
- Explicit handling of token decimals.
- Transaction simulation where supported.
- Contract tests covering adversarial cases.

We should use established libraries such as OpenZeppelin instead of writing foundational security primitives ourselves.

An unaudited hackathon contract must not be marketed as audited or guaranteed safe.

8. Application architecture

Frontend

Next.js + TypeScript

The application should be mobile-first and responsive.

Primary screens:

- Landing page.
- Authentication and wallet onboarding.
- User dashboard.
- Create POT.
- Explore POTs.
- POT details.
- Contribution flow.
- Transaction history.
- User profile.
- Notifications.
- Organizer management.
- Settings.

Backend

Supabase

Responsibilities:

- User profiles.
- Pot metadata.
- Activity feeds.
- Notifications.
- Social interactions.
- Search and discovery.
- Cached blockchain events.
- Analytics.

The database is not the financial source of truth.

The blockchain is authoritative for contribution balances, payout and refund states.

Suggested data model

Table	Purpose
profiles	User information
pots	Pot metadata and configuration
contributions	Indexed contribution records
pot_members	Participation information
activities	Social activity
reactions	Activity reactions
notifications	User notifications

achievements	User achievements
share_events	Growth attribution

Use unique constraints and transaction hashes to prevent duplicate indexing.

Use Supabase Row Level Security for private user information and organizer-only actions.

9. User experience and visual identity

Brand direction

P

POT

Better together.

Money should bring people together, not create friction.

#B7F36B

#141B19

#F4F5EF

Design characteristics

- Premium consumer fintech.
- Minimal, confident typography.
- Deep charcoal and warm off-white.
- Electric lime as the primary accent.
- Excellent number formatting.
- Smooth, restrained animations.
- Clear transaction feedback.
- Human, friendly microcopy.

The interface must not look like a traditional crypto dashboard.

No unnecessary charts, token tickers, gas jargon or blockchain terminology on the primary user journey.

The user should think they are using an excellent payment application, not interacting with a smart contract.

Main navigation

- Home
- Explore
- Create
- Activity
- Profile

The Create action should be the most prominent.

10. Growth and distribution strategy

POT's strongest acquisition channel is the product itself.

Every organizer is a potential acquisition source.

Every participant is a potential future organizer.

Viral loop

```
flowchart TD
 A[User creates POT] --> B[Shares invitation]
 B --> C[Friends join]
 C --> D[Friends contribute]
 D --> E[Group celebrates milestone]
 E --> F[Shareable social card]
 F --> G[New users discover POT]
 G --> H[New POT created]
 H --> A
```

Acquisition channels

WhatsApp

The most important early distribution channel for group collections.

X

Target crypto communities, Base builders, event organizers and consumer fintech audiences.

Telegram

Community collections, creator groups and Web3 communities.

Creator partnerships

Give creators a simple way to organize community contributions for legitimate projects and events.

Base ecosystem

Participate in Base builder communities, showcase real transaction flows and build relationships with ecosystem partners.

Growth features

- One-click invitations.
- Public shareable pot pages.
- QR-code invitations.
- Social progress cards.
- Referral attribution.
- Discoverable public pots.
- Group completion celebrations.

We should not make referrals financially exploitative or reward fake transactions.

11. Business model

POT should begin with free usage and introduce monetization once it has real adoption.

Revenue streams

Product	Monetization
Standard POTs	Free initially
Premium POTs	Fixed or percentage service fee
Organizer Pro	Monthly subscription
Business collections	Transaction/service fee

API access	Usage-based pricing
White-label collections	Business subscription

Potential pricing model

These are hypotheses to test, not finalized prices.

Tier	Potential offering
Free	Basic personal and group pots
Plus	Advanced customization and management
Organizer Pro	Multiple campaigns, analytics and team management
Business	Branded collections and integrations

We should avoid charging a platform fee before making the fee structure transparent and understanding the legal and operational implications.

Long-term business opportunity

POT could evolve into a group-payment infrastructure provider.

Third-party products could use POT's infrastructure to:

- Collect group payments.
- Manage community contributions.
- Coordinate event funding.
- Run shared purchasing campaigns.

- Distribute funds according to predefined rules.

This creates a potential B2B business beyond the consumer application.

12. MVP scope for Vibeathon

The biggest danger is trying to build the entire long-term vision in one week.

We need a tightly controlled MVP.

Must ship

Feature	Priority
Wallet onboarding	P0
Create a POT	P0
Generate shareable link	P0
View public pot	P0
USDC contributions	P0
Live contribution tracking	P0
Organizer dashboard	P0
Target and deadline rules	P0

Payout mechanism	P0
Refund mechanism	P0
Transaction explorer links	P0
Mobile-first design	P0

After MVP

Feature	**Priority**
Social reactions	P1
Achievement system	P1
Public discovery feed	P1
Creator profiles	P1
Premium subscriptions	P1
Advanced analytics	P2

Business API	P2
Multi-chain support	P2

We should not compromise payout and refund security to ship optional social features.

MVP acceptance criteria

The project is not finished until:

- A user can connect a wallet.
- A user can create a pot.
- A second user can access it through an invitation.
- That user can contribute actual testnet USDC.
- The contribution is confirmed on-chain.
- The interface reflects the confirmed balance.
- The configured payout conditions are enforced.
- Refund conditions work correctly.
- Failed and pending transactions are handled correctly.
- The entire experience works on mobile.

13. Seven-day execution roadmap

Competition build window: November 2–9, 2026

- Day 1: Foundation
    - Initialize repository.
    - Establish visual system.
    - Build landing page and navigation.
    - Set up Supabase.
    - Integrate wallet connection.
- Day 2: Blockchain
    - Write POT factory and instance contracts.
    - Implement contribution logic.
    - Implement payout and refund logic.
    - Write unit and adversarial tests.
- Day 3: Core application
    - Create POT workflow.
    - Pot details page.
    - USDC approval and contribution.
    - Transaction confirmation.

- Day 4: Social functionality
    - Invitations.
    - Shareable URLs.
    - Activity feed.
    - Contribution progress.
    - Notifications.
- Day 5: Settlement and security
    - Payout implementation.
    - Refund implementation.
    - Contract testing.
    - Frontend/backend reconciliation.
    - Edge cases.
- Day 6: Product polish
    - Mobile optimization.
    - Loading and error states.
    - Share cards.
    - Accessibility.
    - End-to-end testing.
- Day 7: Launch and submission
    - Mainnet readiness review.
    - Deploy only verified contracts.
    - Production configuration.
    - Demo recording.
    - Documentation.
    - Vibeathon submission.

If mainnet security readiness is not achieved, we should demonstrate the complete functional product on Base Sepolia rather than expose real user funds through unreviewed contracts.

14. Cost and infrastructure strategy

A central requirement is to keep POT inexpensive to operate.

Infrastructure	Initial approach
Frontend	Vercel free tier
Database	Supabase free tier

Blockchain	Base
Development	Base Sepolia
Contract testing	Foundry
Wallet	Free-tier-compatible integration
Analytics	Lightweight, privacy-conscious analytics
Notifications	In-app first
AI	Not required

Operating principles

- No paid AI dependency.
- No unnecessary paid APIs.
- No centralized custody of private keys.
- No mandatory gas sponsorship.
- No unnecessary on-chain writes.
- Cache indexed events.
- Monitor infrastructure quotas.
- Introduce paid services only when usage justifies them.

Our goal is to minimize both founder costs and user transaction friction.

Gas sponsorship should be optional, capped and budget-controlled.

15. Security, compliance and trust

This product handles money belonging to multiple people. Security is a product feature, not a technical afterthought.

Contract security

- Independent review before meaningful mainnet use.
- No unrestricted administrator withdrawal.
- Clear payout authorization.
- Explicit refund conditions.
- No double spending or double refunds.
- Reentrancy protection.
- Emergency handling designed without giving administrators arbitrary custody.

Product trust

- Transparent fees.
- Clear contribution terms.
- Clear refund terms.
- Visible transaction records.
- Honest transaction status.
- No misleading funding progress.
- No false claims of insurance or guaranteed recovery.

Regulatory considerations

Before public commercial launch, we must assess applicable payment services, custody, money transmission, consumer protection, fundraising and AML requirements in each target market.

Using USDC and smart contracts does not automatically exempt the business from financial regulation.

We should also establish a process for fraudulent collections, impersonation and abusive campaigns.

16. Success metrics

We should measure actual product usage, not just wallet connections.

North Star metric

Successfully completed pots per week.

A completed pot means it has reached a valid terminal outcome under its configured rules, such as successful payout or refund resolution.

Supporting metrics

Metric	What it tells us
Pots created	Product demand
Invitation conversion	Distribution effectiveness
Contributors per pot	Network participation
Contribution completion rate	Payment UX
Funded pots	Product utility
Payout success rate	Financial reliability
Repeat organizers	Retention
New pots per acquired user	Organic growth
Cost per active user	Sustainability

Initial validation targets

These are proposed goals for the first public pilot, not predictions.

- 50 created pots.
- 100 unique participants.
- 10 successfully resolved pots.
- At least 30% of organizers create another pot.

- At least 40% invitation-to-participation conversion.
- Zero unresolved accounting discrepancies.

We should revise these targets using actual pilot data.

17. Long-term product roadmap

Phase 1: Consumer MVP

Create pots, invite friends, collect USDC, track contributions and settle funds.

Vibeathon

Phase 2: Social growth

Public discovery, profiles, achievements, reactions, group activity and better sharing.

Phase 3: Commerce

Event collections, business collections, creator funding, group purchases and premium organizers.

Phase 4: Infrastructure

POT APIs, embeddable collections, merchant integrations and programmable group-payment infrastructure.

18. What winning looks like

We should enter Vibeathon with a product judges can understand in 15 seconds and a demonstration they can remember.

Our demo narrative:

- A person needs to organize a birthday gift.
- They create a POT in seconds.
- They share it with friends.
- A friend opens the link without needing to understand Web3.
- The friend contributes USDC on Base.
- The contribution appears in the shared dashboard.
- The target is reached.
- The organizer executes the permitted payout.
- The transaction is independently verifiable on BaseScan.

The judges should see an actual consumer problem being solved through blockchain infrastructure.

The most important part of our presentation is not the technology stack. It’s the complete user experience.

19. Final product strategy

POT

Money moves better together.

Product category: Consumer fintech / On-chain payments.

Primary network: Base.

Primary asset: USDC.

Primary user: Someone organizing a shared financial goal.

Primary action: Create and share a POT.

Primary growth mechanism: Group invitations.

Primary retention mechanism: Repeated group financial coordination.

Primary revenue opportunity: Premium organizers, business collections and payment infrastructure.

Long-term ambition: Become the easiest way for people and communities to coordinate money together.

My final product-manager verdict

POT should not try to become another wallet, crowdfunding platform or social network.

It should own a very specific behaviour:

When people need to put money together, they think of POT.

That is the product identity we should build around.

The hackathon version should be small enough to finish, complete enough to demonstrate genuine value, and architected so we can continue building it after November 9.

The vision is ambitious. The MVP must be disciplined.

End of product vision.